Frequently Asked Questions

Cosmic Calculation Series · Teaching logistics

What is the Cosmic Calculation Series?

A planned collection of astronomy learning materials organized around the IOAA syllabus. It is intended to support both physical understanding and curiosity about the universe.

Are the problems and solutions available?

Original problem sets are available for the five Basic Astrophysics topics and the two Coordinates and Times topics. All other problem PDFs and every Solutions PDF are placeholders marked “To be Added!”

What background does the syllabus require?

The IOAA syllabus requires high-school physics and mathematics. Standard solutions should not require complex numbers or solving differential equations. The listed mathematical methods include basic calculus.

What does (Q) mean?

Qualitative understanding only. Quantitative reasoning or proficiency in topics marked (Q) is not mandatory.

Is this an official IOAA publication?

No. This is a MAIS PAC study resource. The syllabus PDF is a reformatted reproduction of the syllabus published on the IOAA 2026 website, which credits IOAA and an update of 17 November 2021. The topic codes and practical-topic labels are club organizational aids.

Where are the existing club handouts?

The existing introductory physics and astronomy handouts remain available in the Teaching page’s “Existing club handouts” section. They are separate from the Cosmic Calculation Series.